

Daily Negatives Sweeper Walkthrough

Built by Shah — what the Search (and PMax) negative keyword sweeper does every day

Audience: Account managers and ops

Scripts: Search sweeper + optional PMax sister sweeper

Not the Engine: This is a separate MCC Google Ads Script. It does not live inside the metrics Engine.

Guide in repo: docs/Read this for the Search negatives sweeper – auto-add review and remove on the spoke.md

1. One-sentence summary

Every scheduled day, the sweeper looks at the **last seven completed days** of search terms for each enabled shop, finds low-value queries that match your body-shop rules, adds the **full query** as an **exact-match campaign negative**, logs it on that shop's spoke **Negatives Audit** tab, and (if an AM checked Remove earlier) deletes those flagged negatives on the next run.

2. How it fits the Hub-and-Spoke system

Piece	Role for negatives
Hub Config	On/off per shop, due-queue stamp, rule overrides (disable rules, protect phrases, local competitors)
Search / PMax sweeper scripts	MCC scripts that read the Hub, change Google Ads negatives, write the spoke audit tab
Spoke Negatives Audit	Per-shop log of what was added; AM marks Reviewed / Remove
Engine	Metrics + goal sync only — does not add negatives

Both switches required for a shop to run:

Hub **Enabled** = Enabled **and** Hub **Negatives Sweeper Enabled** = Enabled **and** Spoke Spreadsheet URL filled in.

3. What happens on a normal daily run

Example: you schedule the Search sweeper Daily at 7:00 AM Pacific (and again at 8:00 AM for shops 51–70).

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MCC Scripts clock fires
→ main() opens Hub
→ finds shops due today (≤50)
→ runs those shops in parallel
→ for each shop: Remove flagged rows → scan seven completed days → add exact
negatives → write spoke
→ stamps Hub "Negatives Last Successful Run" when the shop finished cleanly
```

Step A — Wake up and read the Hub

1. Opens the Hub spreadsheet URL from script config.
2. Makes sure Negatives columns exist on Config (can append missing ones).
3. Builds the candidate list of shops where:
 - **Enabled** is on
 - **Negatives Sweeper Enabled** is on
 - **Spoke Spreadsheet URL** is present
4. Keeps only shops still **due today**: Negatives Last Successful Run is blank or not today's date (PMax uses its own stamp: Negatives PMax Last Successful Run).
5. Sorts by Priority (higher first), then Account ID.
6. Takes up to **50 shops** (Google's hard parallel limit).

Step B — Process each shop (in parallel)

For every selected shop, the script switches into that Google Ads account and does the following.

Step C — Remove pass first (undo yesterday's bad blocks)

1. Opens that shop's spoke → **Negatives Audit**.
2. Finds rows where **Remove** is checked, Status is **ADDED**, and Channel matches this script (SEARCH or PMAX).
3. Deletes that exact campaign negative from Google Ads.
4. Updates the row to Status **REMOVED** and fills **Removed At**.
5. Does **not** clear your Reviewed / Remove checkboxes or AM Notes.

Step D — Pull the rolling seven-day search-term window

1. Uses the **Google Ads account time zone** (not UTC).
2. Looks at the most recent **seven completed days**, always ending yesterday.

3. Re-reading recent days is intentional. Google normally finishes prior-day Search terms around 6:00 AM in the account's local time, so late-published terms get another chance on later runs.
4. Also loads about **30 days** of history for conversion guarding and lookback spend.
5. Search sweeper: Search campaigns only.
6. PMax sweeper: Performance Max campaigns only (same spoke tab, Channel = PMAX).
7. Only terms with at least **1 impression** are considered.

Step E — Match against the rule brain

Each search term is checked against the shared rule list (examples):

- Minor / low-intent themes: dent, bumper, paint, scratch, ding, detailing, tint, glass, coupon, cheap, etc.
- Many rules have **exceptions** (example: “dent” + “insurance” is protected for that rule).
- **CHEAP**: cheap / cheapest / cheaply
- **LOCAL_COMPETITOR**: seed chains + Hub **Negatives Competitor Phrases**
- Hub can disable rules per shop via **Negatives Disabled Rule IDs**
- Hub **Negatives Protected Phrases** plus Client Name / Account Name block auto-negatives on brand / specialty queries

Matching is word-boundary aware (example: “glass” does not match “fiberglass”).

Step F — Safety gates before any Ads change

A matching term is still skipped if any of these are true:

Gate	Meaning
Converted in action window	Has primary conversions in the rolling seven completed days
Converted in lookback	Has primary conversions in the ~30-day guard window
Already ADDED / EXCLUDED	Google already marks the term as added or excluded
Already covered	An existing campaign or attached shared-list negative already blocks it
Protected	Every matched rule was exception-protected or Hub-protected
Too long	Would exceed Google's 80-character or 10-word keyword limits → logged as MANUAL_REVIEW, not added

Step G — Add exact campaign negatives

1. Sorts remaining candidates by spend (worst waste first).
2. For each eligible term, adds the **full search term** as an exact negative, like [cheap auto body near me].
3. Adds at **campaign** level (not ad group).
4. Never auto-adds bare trigger words as broad or phrase negatives.
5. Does not write into shared negative lists (it only reads them for coverage checks).
6. Processes **all** eligible terms in that run (no “only 10 per campaign” product cap).
7. Keeps a high runaway safety ceiling (~500 adds per account per run). If hit, the shop is **not** stamped done so the next wave can finish the rest.

Step H — Write the spoke Negatives Audit tab

For each actionable result, a new row is written under the header (newest on top) with:

- Date, Channel, Campaign, Search Term, Exact Negative, Matched Rules
- Impressions, Clicks, Cost Yesterday, Cost Lookback, Conversions
- Spend Summary (short blurb like “\$12.40 lookback / \$3.10 yesterday / 0 conv”)
- Decision + Reason
- Empty Reviewed / Remove checkboxes for the AM
- Status such as ADDED, MANUAL_REVIEW, FAILED, or REMOVED

Step I — Stamp the Hub due queue

If the shop finished successfully and did not hit the safety ceiling, the script stamps today’s date on:

- Search sweeper → **Negatives Last Successful Run**
- PMax sweeper → **Negatives PMax Last Successful Run**

That shop is then skipped until tomorrow (unless you clear the stamp to force a re-run).

4. What the account manager does each day

1. Open the shop spoke → **Daily Checklist** → Negatives audit status.
2. Open **Negatives Audit**.
3. Scan new rows (spend summary helps prioritize).
4. Check **Reviewed** when the add looks correct.
5. Check **Remove** if the negative was a mistake — the **next** sweeper run deletes it in Google Ads.

6. Shop-specific rule tweaks (glass shop, local competitor, protect a phrase) happen on the **Hub**, not on the spoke.

5. Where do I edit what?

I want to...	Go here
Turn Engine + negatives off for a shop	Hub → Enabled = Disabled
Keep metrics, stop auto-negatives	Hub → Negatives Sweeper Enabled = Disabled
Turn auto-negatives on	Hub → Enabled + Negatives Sweeper Enabled + Spoke URL
Disable a rule for one shop	Hub → Negatives Disabled Rule IDs (example: AUTO_GLASS, PAINTLESS_DENT)
Protect a specialty phrase	Hub → Negatives Protected Phrases
Add a local competitor name	Hub → Negatives Competitor Phrases
Review / undo an add	Spoke → Negatives Audit (Reviewed / Remove)
Change agency-wide triggers for everyone	Script update (developer)

6. Scheduling reality (~70 shops)

Google only allows **50 accounts per script run**. With about 70 shops, schedule the **same** sweeper code at least **twice daily** (two Scripts rows, identical code, same Hub URL — for example 7:00 and 8:00 AM Pacific). Do the same separately for PMax if you install that sister script. Do **not** create a second Hub.

7. What this script never does

- Does not live inside the Engine
- Does not dump all shops' negatives into one shared Sheet
- Does not auto-add broad/phrase bare trigger words
- Does not write shared negative lists
- Does not use a DRY_RUN / LIVE mode switch (Hub Enabled columns control whether a shop runs)
- Google Preview still never changes Ads if someone clicks Preview

8. End-of-day mental model

Hub decides who is allowed to be swept and which shop-specific exceptions apply.

Sweeper finds junk queries from the rolling seven completed days, adds exact campaign negatives, and logs them.

Spoke is where the human double-checks and can request a Remove on the next run.

Built by Shah — Google Ads Management Scripts

Search script: [scripts/built-by-shah-mcc-search-negatives-sweeper.js](#)

PMax script: [scripts/built-by-shah-mcc-pmax-negatives-sweeper.js](#)

Generated for operators — keep this PDF with your Hub / spoke install notes.